

CHAPTER 1

A Letter to God

NCERT Exercise Solutions

Let's Begin	3 Q
Reading Comprehension · Text I: The Trader and the Tailor	1 Q
Vocabulary	1 Q
Grammar	1 Q
Editing	1 Q
Listening	1 Q
Speaking	2 Q
Writing	2 Q
Project	1 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

Independent study aid by Beginers Point. Not an official NCERT publication.

⭐ Let's Begin

1 **You have read about Lencho in ‘A Letter to God’, First Flight, textbook in English for Class X. How has the story of Lencho moved you? What do you think about Lencho’s faith in God and his attitude towards the officials in the post office? Do you think he is right in asking God for support and then blaming the people at the post office? Discuss his actions with your friends. Why does he do so?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- The story moves us because a poor farmer loses his whole crop in one night, yet he does not lose hope. His faith in God is **total and unshaken**.
- His faith is simple and pure, like a child’s. He believes God sees everything and will surely help him.
- His attitude towards the post office officials is **unfair and ungrateful**. They helped him with their own money, but he called them “a bunch of crooks”.
- Asking God for help is natural for him, but blaming the post office people is not right, because he has no proof.

- He does so because his faith tells him **God cannot make a mistake**, so if 30 pesos are missing, someone else must have taken them. The irony is that the people he blames are the ones who helped him.

2 **The summary of the story of Lencho is given below. The sequence of the story is jumbled up. Read the story again and rearrange the jumbled sentences to make a coherent story. Write the correct order in numbers.**

(i) But it rained heavily and hailstorm thrashed his corn field and all the corn was destroyed.

(ii) He wrote 'To God' on the envelope and posted it.

(iii) Lencho predicted it will rain and it did. He and his wife were happy.

(iv) Lencho felt desperate but believed that God would help him.

(v) Their corn field was longing for water.

(vi) The postman and the postmaster laughed at Lencho's letter but were surprised by the faith of the man.

(vii) He wrote a letter to God asking for a hundred pesos to sow his field again and to survive until the next crop came up.

(viii) After some days, Lencho went to the post office to receive the money as the postmaster watched him.

(ix) He immediately went to the counter and asked for a pen and paper, wrote a few lines and posted the letter.

(x) Lencho, his wife, and their children lived in a lonely house in a valley.

(xi) When the postmaster opened the letter, it said "Oh! Thanks for sending the money. But I have received only seventy pesos. ... They have taken the thirty pesos."

(xii) He opened the letter and was happy to find the money. He counted and found it was only seventy pesos.

(xiii) The postmaster collected about 70 pesos from his colleagues and sent it to Lencho.

✔ ANSWER

Numbers to write in the column (in the order the sentences are printed):

Sentence	Order
(i) It rained heavily and hailstorm destroyed the corn	4
(ii) He wrote 'To God' on the envelope and posted it	7
(iii) Lencho predicted rain and it did	3
(iv) Lencho felt desperate but believed God would help	5
(v) Their corn field was longing for water	2
(vi) Postman and postmaster laughed but were surprised	8

(vii) He wrote a letter to God asking for a hundred pesos	6
(viii) After some days Lencho went to the post office	10
(ix) He went to the counter, asked for pen and paper	12
(x) Lencho and his family lived in a lonely house in a valley	1
(xi) The postmaster opened the letter: "...only seventy pesos"	13
(xii) He opened the letter, found only seventy pesos	11
(xiii) The postmaster collected about 70 pesos and sent it	9

Correct story order: (x) → (v) → (iii) → (i) → (iv) → (vii) → (ii) → (vi) → (xiii) → (viii) → (xii) → (ix) → (xi).

3 **Create a graphic description based on the given summary of 'A Letter to God'.**

A. Lencho in his corn field.

B. _____

C. _____

D. _____

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Draw four boxes (like a comic strip), each with a picture and one line below it:

- **A. Lencho in his corn field:** Lencho stands on the hill near his house, looking at his ripe corn and the rain clouds in the sky.

- **B. The hailstorm:** Big hailstones fall; the field is white “as if covered with salt”; Lencho and his family look sad.
- **C. The letter to God:** Lencho writes a letter asking God for a hundred pesos; the postmaster laughs, then collects money from his staff.
- **D. At the post office:** Lencho counts seventy pesos, gets angry and writes a second letter calling the post office employees “a bunch of crooks”.

Reading Comprehension · Text I: The Trader and the Tailor

1 **Did you enjoy the story of ‘The Trader and the Tailor’? The story is summarised below. Read the story again with your friend and complete the paragraph using short sentences with the given hints.**

Once there was a tailor who was known for _____ (cheat and thievery). He could cheat anyone with his cunning way of deceiving people. A trader challenged that the tailor would not be able to cheat him. He _____ (go) to the tailor with _____ (satin). The tailor _____ (welcome). The trader _____ (please) by the tailor’s praise. He told the tailor to make a coat for him. The tailor _____ (praise) the trader _____ (maximum). The trader _____ (joy). The tailor _____ (recount) funny tales and the trader forgot _____ (bet). The

tailor started snipping _____ and _____ (hide). Eyes of the trader _____ (tears and joy) and yet the trader kept on asking for _____ (stories). At last, the tailor told the trader that _____ (tight) and _____ (weep-blood).

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Once there was a tailor who was known for **his skill in cheating and thievery**. He could cheat anyone with his cunning way of deceiving people. A trader challenged that the tailor would not be able to cheat him. He **went** to the tailor with **a piece of satin cloth**. The tailor **welcomed him warmly**. The trader **was pleased** by the tailor's praise. He told the tailor to make a coat for him. The tailor **praised** the trader **to the maximum**. The trader **was filled with joy**. The tailor **recounted** funny tales and the trader forgot **all about his bet**. The tailor started snipping **extra pieces of the cloth** and **hid them under his thighs**. Eyes of the trader **were full of tears of joy** and yet the trader kept on asking for **more stories**. At last, the tailor told the trader that **if he told another story, the coat would be too tight for him** and **he would weep tears of blood**.

⭐ Vocabulary

1 **Use appropriate words and fill in the blanks: light-headed, light year, light-hearted, light**

sleeper, light-duty

(a) The _____ is a unit of distance used to measure distance in space.

(b) The farmer bought a _____ truck to transport their produce, as it uses less diesel.

(c) We had a fairly _____ discussion with our colleagues.

(d) Rita felt dizzy and _____ after skydiving.

(e) He is a _____, a slightest noise wakes him.

✔ ANSWER

(a) **light year**

(b) **light-duty**

(c) **light-hearted**

(d) **light-headed**

(e) **light sleeper**

⭐ Grammar

1 Complete the sentences given below by adding the most suitable clause from the box and make it a relative clause. The first one has been done for you.

Box: contains meaning of words; stitches clothes; tell lies; won the best actor award this year; hit a century; is faithful; need to fill in the application; is a crook; help themselves; won the nobel prize; believe in hard work

(a) A tailor is a person who stitches clothes.

(b) A dictionary is a book _____

(c) The book is about a scientist _____

(d) What is the name of the player _____

(e) I don't like people _____

(f) What is the name of the actor _____

(g) Students _____ should meet the principal in her office.

(h) Friends of the trader thought the tailor _____ and can cheat anyone.

(i) Lencho _____ thought God would help him.

(j) Those _____ will succeed.

(k) God helps those _____

✔ ANSWER

(b) A dictionary is a book **which contains meaning of words**.

(c) The book is about a scientist **who won the Nobel Prize**.

(d) What is the name of the player **who hit a century**?

(e) I don't like people **who tell lies**.

(f) What is the name of the actor **who won the best actor award this year**?

(g) Students **who need to fill in the application** should meet the principal in her office.

(h) Friends of the trader thought the tailor **is a crook** and can cheat anyone.

(i) Lencho, **who is faithful**, thought God would help him.

(j) Those **who believe in hard work** will succeed.

(k) God helps those **who help themselves**.

⭐ Editing

1 **Suppose Lencho gets a hundred pesos in his envelope. He writes a letter to God expressing his gratitude. However, he has missed a word in each line. Help him with those words so that his letter is complete.**

Dear God!

Thank for — Thank you for

(a) sending a hundred pesos help.

(b) I am very for this kind gesture.

(c) You were my only and your

(d) help has my faith in you.

(e) This money will help me until the crop

(f) and I promise to hard in the future.

Sincerely yours, Lencho

✔ ANSWER

Line	Missing word	Correct line
(a)	as	sending a hundred pesos **as** help.
(b)	grateful	I am very **grateful** for this kind gesture.
(c)	hope	You were my only **hope** and your

(d)	strengthened	help has **strengthened** my faith in you.
(e)	grows	This money will help me until the crop **grows**
(f)	work	and I promise to **work** hard in the future.

Other correct words: (a) **for** help; (b) **thankful**; (d) **increased / restored**; (e) until the **next** crop.

⭐ Listening

1 **Here is an interesting story. The story has been told in two ways. Story A has all the odd sentences (1,3,5,...) and story B has the even sentences (2,4,6,...). Working in pairs, one of you take up Story A and the other take up Story B. The person with Story A will read out the first sentence and the partner will write it. Then the person with Story B will read sentence two and the partner will write it. Likewise complete the whole story.**

The Race

✔ ANSWER

The complete story (odd sentences from Story A, even sentences from Story B):

The Race

1. Every evening the animals of the Machlipatti used to sit under the banyan tree.

2. One day Kho-Kho, the rabbit, was feeling bored.

3. He said, “Let’s run a race!” “Who will run a race with you?

4. No one can run faster than you,” said Bhalu, the bear, eating a mango.

5. Choo-Choo, the rat, shouted, “No, he’s not the fastest runner.

6. I can run faster than him.”

7. Everyone laughed at him.

8. Then it was decided to have a race between Kho-Kho and Choo-Choo.

9. The starting point was the peepul tree and the finishing point was the neem tree.

10. Coocku, the cock, crowed to start the race.

11. Kho-Kho and Choo-Choo started running.

12. After running half the distance, Kho-Kho looked back but Choo-Choo was nowhere to be seen.

13. “He must be far behind.”

14. When he was near the finishing point, Choo-Choo jumped over Kho-Kho’s shoulder and touched the neem tree first.

15. He shouted, “I’ve won the race! I’ve won the race!”

16. Everyone cheered for Choo-Choo.

(Sentence 13 may be read as Kho-Kho’s thought: “He must be far behind,” he thought.)

⭐ Speaking

1 **Lencho's complete faith in God is amazing during the calamity. So, one type of conflict dominating in the story is man versus nature. Discuss with your partner the natural calamities that play havoc in the lives of people. Collect photographs and make a visual presentation to share in the class.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Points for the discussion and presentation (one slide or chart per calamity, with a photo):

- **Floods:** heavy rain overflows rivers (Assam, Bihar, Kerala 2018); homes, crops and cattle are lost.
- **Drought:** no rain for a long time; crops fail, farmers fall into debt, drinking water becomes scarce.
- **Hailstorms and unseasonal rain:** destroy ready crops in a few minutes, like Lencho's corn.
- **Cyclones:** strong winds and sea water hit coastal areas (Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat).
- **Earthquakes and landslides:** buildings collapse; hill roads are blocked (Gujarat 2001, Uttarakhand).

- **What helps:** early warnings, crop insurance, disaster relief teams (NDRF), and people helping one another — just as the post office employees helped Lencho.

2 **Try writing a small poem on the topic man versus nature. Read aloud the poem with the required stress and intonation. (A poem by Norman Littleford, 'Man vs Nature', is given to help you.)**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Model poem: The Farmer and the Sky

I sowed my seeds with hope and care,
I watched the clouds float in the air;
The rain came down, my heart was glad,
Then hail came too, and all went bad.
The river rose, the wind did roar,
It broke my fence, it broke my door;
Yet Nature gives us food and rain,
So we must care for her again.
We cut her trees, we dig her land,
Then blame the storm we don't understand;
Let man and Nature walk as friends,
And every quarrel quickly ends.

Tip for reading aloud: stress the key words (**hope, hail, roar, friends**), pause at the end of each line, and let your voice rise for anger and fall for sadness.

⭐ Writing

1 The tailor here is a cheat, but Lencho in the story, 'A Letter to God', is naive and simple. He has immense faith in God. How do you distinguish between Lencho and the tailor? What makes them different? Working in pairs, list the actions and qualities of Lencho and the tailor and draw their character sketches.

Action: What does the person do?	What quality it reveals?
Lencho lost all his crops.	He is helpless. Prays to God.
How does he manage the situation? _____	_____
Does he harm anyone by his action? _____	_____
How do others think of him? _____	_____
What is your judgement of him? _____	_____
He received 70 pesos and he thought 30 pesos had been stolen.	_____

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Action: What does the person do?	What quality it reveals?
Lencho lost all his crops.	He is helpless. Prays to God.

How does he manage the situation? He writes a letter to God asking for a hundred pesos.	Deep, simple faith in God; hopeful even in trouble.
Does he harm anyone by his action? No, he harms no one.	He is honest and innocent.
How do others think of him? The postmaster thinks he is a man of great faith and wants to keep his faith alive.	People respect his faith, though they find him naive.
What is your judgement of him? He is a good, hard-working but naive farmer.	Simple-minded, trusting God fully.
He received 70 pesos and he thought 30 pesos had been stolen.	Ungrateful and suspicious of people; he believes God cannot make a mistake.

Character sketch of Lencho: Lencho is a poor, hard-working farmer who lives with his family in a lonely house in a valley. He knows his field well and loves his crop. When a hailstorm destroys it, he is sad but does not lose hope, because he has **unshaken faith in God**. He writes a letter to God for a hundred pesos — this shows his **simplicity and innocence**. He harms no one. However, when he gets only seventy pesos, he calls the post office employees “a bunch of crooks”. This shows that he trusts God completely but **distrusts people**, and is unknowingly ungrateful to those who helped him.

Character sketch of the tailor: The tailor is clever, cunning and a skilled cheat, famous for being "light-fingered". He is a **sweet talker**: he welcomes the trader with great warmth and tells funny stories and jokes. While the trader laughs, he quickly cuts and hides extra pieces of satin. He is **dishonest and greedy**, and uses his charm to fool people. He is also confident and witty, as his last warning shows: another tale would make the coat too tight.

Difference: Lencho is honest, simple and trusts God; the tailor is dishonest, smart and trusts only his own cunning. Lencho blames others wrongly; the tailor actually cheats others.

2 **Writing a portrait or description of a person. Read the following description about two persons, Raavi and Mohini.**

Raavi	Mohini
A portrait or a picture of a handsome young man in full sleeves shirt.	A portrait or a picture of a middle aged lady who is a singer.
Raavi is an engineer in a manufacturing firm.	She studied music and became a playback singer.
He likes to make, fix, and repair things.	She likes to be with people and participates in social functions.
He loves to watch television and goes to the movies thrice a month.	She loves music and reading books.

He is congenial and supportive.	She is firm and a lady with a purpose.
He does not like to play, but goes for a morning walk everyday.	She does not get time to exercise.

Now, write a description of any one of the above based on the details given, following the process approach (brainstorming, outlining, drafting, revising, proofreading, final draft).

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Step 1 – Points (adjectives) for Raavi: handsome, young, neat, skilled, practical, hard-working, fond of films, friendly (congenial), helpful (supportive), disciplined.

Step 2 – Outline: looks → job → hobbies → nature → daily habit.

Final draft – Raavi

Raavi is a handsome young man who is usually seen in a neat full-sleeved shirt. He is an engineer in a manufacturing firm and is very good at his work. He enjoys making, fixing and repairing things, so whenever a machine at home or at work breaks down, everyone calls Raavi. In his free time he loves to watch television, and he goes to the movies three times a month. Raavi is congenial and supportive by nature; he gets along well with everyone and is always ready to help his friends and colleagues. Though he does not like to play games, he takes care of his health by going for a morning walk every day. Raavi is a practical, friendly and disciplined young man.

Final draft – Mohini (alternative)

Mohini is a graceful middle-aged lady and a well-known playback singer. She studied music and worked hard to reach where she is today. She loves music and reading books, and she likes to be with people, so she often takes part in social functions. Mohini is firm and has a clear purpose in life; once she decides something, she works till it is done. Her busy schedule leaves her no time to exercise, but her love for music keeps her cheerful. She is a talented, sociable and determined woman.

🛠️ Project

1 You may have come across some people in your neighbourhood who might have inspired you with their actions. Talk to them about—

- their childhood, their education, job, their likes and dislikes
- their contribution to the enrichment of their village or town, job, country, etc.
- their interesting features and characteristics

Request for their pictures. Based on the collected information, write their portraits and present it to the class.

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

How to do it: make a question list, meet the person, take notes (field notes), ask for a photo, then write, edit and present (process approach).

Model portrait – Shri Ramesh Kumar, our retired school teacher

Shri Ramesh Kumar, aged 68, grew up in a poor farmer's family in our village. He walked five kilometres every day to school and later became a science teacher. He likes gardening, reading newspapers and early-morning walks, and dislikes waste of food and water. After retiring, he started free evening classes for children of daily-wage workers in the village temple courtyard; more than fifty children have passed Class 10 with his help. He also planted over two hundred trees along the village road. He is a tall, thin man with a gentle smile who always carries a cloth bag full of books. He is patient, generous and disciplined. His life teaches us that one person's effort can change a whole village.

(Write about a real person you meet; paste their photo with the portrait.)

🎉 **Chapter 1 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**